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★ FREE CHEAT SHEET · THE AI CUT

My AI Stack

Claude, skills and code-based motion

14+ years of hand-cut keyframes in After Effects, and now Claude at the center of everything around them: a second brain, a builder, and a set of skills that turn my way of working into something it repeats on every project. Plus Remotion and HyperFrames for video made with code.

01 The workflow at a glance

02 Claude at the center

03 A skill, up close

04 Video as code: Remotion & HyperFrames

05 The rest of the kit

06 The one-line test

01 The workflow at a glance

One product video, start to finish. After Effects is still the craft core. Claude sits behind almost every other step.

01	02	03	04	05	06
Brief	**Script**	**Voice**	**Visuals**	**Motion**	**Captions**
ChatGPT · NotebookLM · Claude	Claude	ElevenLabs	ChatGPT · Seedance 2.0 · Figma	After Effects · Remotion · HyperFrames	WhisperX via Claude Code

02 Claude at the center

If I could keep only one AI tool, it would be Claude. Hand on heart.

1 **Claude** THE SECOND BRAIN

Thinking things through, longer-form writing (this whole site included), turning a messy brief into a plan. On an ordinary day it is a cheap student doing the legwork. On a hard day it is a cheap specialist who knows the niche stuff.

2 **Claude Code** THE BUILDER

I describe the tool I need, it builds it. My caption pipeline around WhisperX came out of it, and so does most of my code-based video work in Remotion. I am an animator, not a developer, and I no longer need to be one.

3 **Skills** MY WORKFLOW, PACKAGED

A skill is a written-down way of working that Claude follows every time: the steps, the scripts, the rules, my taste. I write one once, and the next project starts from my process instead of a blank chat.

03 A skill, up close

My social video editing skill in Remotion. I hand Claude the raw footage and one line of direction, and the skill does the rest the way I would:

SKILL · SOCIAL VIDEO EDIT

CLAUDE CODE + REMOTION

- → Transcribes the footage and suggests the cuts
- → Renders 9:16, 4:5, 1:1 and 16:9 from one edit, plus hook variants for testing
- → Pulls from a library of 50 sound effects
- → Adds captions, zooms and callouts, and checks they sit inside each platform's safe zones
- → Applies the client's brand profile: fonts, colours, CTA style
- → Knows my taste: no lens flares, no light leaks, no flashes

Why it matters A prompt gets you a result once. A skill gets you *your* result every time, because the process, the scripts and the taste are written down where Claude can follow them.

04 Video as code: Remotion & HyperFrames

The biggest shift in my motion work: some videos are now written, not keyframed. When a video is code, Claude can build it, change it and render ten versions of it.

Remotion

VIDEOS WRITTEN IN REACT

My default for new code-based edits. Every frame is a component, so a new aspect ratio, a new hook or a new brand is a change in code, not a re-edit. My editing skill runs on it.

HyperFrames

HTML & CSS INTO MP4

HeyGen's open-source renderer, built for AI agents: a web page goes in, a video comes out. A lighter option when a piece is basically a page that moves.

After Effects is not going anywhere. Hand-crafted motion is still where the craft lives. Code takes over the repeatable work around it: variants, formats, captions.

05 The rest of the kit

TOOL	WHAT I USE IT FOR	COST
ChatGPT	Copy, client emails, research, strategy, key frames for video	Free tier
ElevenLabs	Placeholder voiceover and dubbing into other languages	Free tier
Seedance 2.0	Animates a ChatGPT key frame into the shot stock doesn't have	Paid, cheaper than alternatives
WhisperX	Accurate captions, run through my own Claude Code pipeline	Open source + compute
NotebookLM	Summarizing a messy brief across several docs	Free
CapCut	Fast auto-captions for a first pass	Free
Figma	UI mockups and device frames	Free tier
Pexels · Pixabay · Mixkit	Stock video, photos and B-roll	Free
YouTube Audio Library · Pixabay Music	Music and SFX	Free, commercial use
Screen Studio *	Screen recording for product videos	Paid

* Affiliate link: screenstudio.lemonsqueezy.com. I earn a small commission, you pay the same.

06 The one-line test

Does this remove a step, or add one more place I have to check?

A tool that saves ten minutes but needs a full re-check every time has not saved ten minutes.

The one that didn't make it: captions.ai. Fix one line and it regenerated everything. Once a tool I already used could do the same job without that tax, it was gone.

The list gets reviewed roughly every quarter.

Steal the stack, not the logos

The tools will change. The approach won't: put one strong assistant at the center, write your process down as skills, and turn the repeatable parts of your craft into code.

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